

1. datasette 1.0a32

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-31T23:23:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/31/datasette/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette 1.0a32 A minor bugfix release. Fixes a bug with INSERT ... RETURNING queries via the new /db/-/execute-write endpoint and a bunch of base_url issues which showed up when I was experimenting with Service Workers yesterday. Tags: datasette , annotated-release-notes

2. The solution might be cancelling my AI subscription

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-31T16:31:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/31/the-solution-might-be-cancelling-my-ai-subscription/#atom-everything>

The solution might be cancelling my AI subscription I find this post by David Wilson very relatable. David lists 16+ projects he's spun up with AI tooling, and concludes: I didn't mean to build most of these things. Usually the Claude session started with something like " write a quick script for X ", and one hour later the result is not a quick script for X , nor in the usual case is my problem solved, whatever the original itch happened to be. On that last point, this technology is horrific for attention. It's a thermonuclear ADHD amplifier and I have seen the same effect in every single one of my adult friends. Folk running 3 screens simultaneously working on totally unrelated "projects" they have little hope of maintaining, and such little commitment to the outcome that the time is obviously wasted. This is a very real problem. I'm finding that coding agents can take me from a vague idea to a working solution, one with tests and documentation and that looks like a carefully considered project evolved over the course of many weeks... in less than an hour. Even if the code is rock solid, there's a limit to how many projects like that I can sensibly care for - and if they're inst...

3. Quoting Karen Kwok for Reuters Breakingviews

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-31T01:48:12+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/31/anthropic-run-rate/#atom-everything>

Anthropic defines ?run-rate revenue? in two parts. Use the last 28 days of sales ?from customers charged on a consumption basis and multiply it by 13. Then, multiply the monthly subscription take by 12, ?and add the two together. ? Karen Kwok for Reuters Breakingviews , citing "a person familiar with the matter" Tags: anthropic , ai

4. The Talk Show Live From WWDC 2026: Tuesday June 9

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-01T01:33:14Z

Link: <https://ti.to/daringfireball/the-talk-show-live-from-wwdc-2026>

Location: The California Theatre, San Jose Showtime: Tuesday, 9 June 2026, 7pm PT (Doors open 6pm) Special Guest(s): For sure Price: \$45 The annual live audience episode of The Talk Show during the week of WWDC. If you can make it, you should come. You'll even enjoy the prelude, mingling with fellow DF readers and listeners. Also: at least one sponsorship slot is still available. If you've got a product or service you'd like to see me promote at the start of the show, shoot me an email . ?

5. Take Two

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-01T00:15:44Z

Link: <https://x.com/markgurman/status/2061236259843182813>

Mark Gurman, on Twitter/X (XCancel link) Kelsey Peterson, the Apple AI employee who introduced the never-launched Siri revamp in 2024, just started at OpenAI ? so we'll be getting someone new next month for Attempt 2 at WWDC. Pretty sure we were going to get someone different for the second crack at a next-gen Siri introduction at WWDC no matter what. If they had made a Titanic II, they would have hired someone new to host the christening. ?

6. Build agents, not pipelines

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 31 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/build-agents-not-pipelines/>

There are only two ways to use LLMs in a computer program: as part of a pipeline, or as an agent. In other words, either you express the control flow of the program in code, or you give a LLM tools and allow it to manage the control flow itself 1 . Here's how you might structure a trivial "summarize a bunch of information and email it to me" program as a pipeline: context = gather_context (various , data , sources) llm_response = llm_summarize (context) summary = parse (llm_response) email_me (summary , my_email) And here's how you'd do it as an agent: read_data_tool = build_read_data_tool (various , data , sources) email_tool = build_email_tool (my_email) run_agent (tools : [read_data_tool , email_tool]) It's like the difference between a library and a framework. When you use a library, you define the structure of the program yourself, and call out to various library helpers along the way. When you use a framework, the main structure of the program lives in the framework, and it calls your code at various points. There are tradeoffs involved in both approaches. Frameworks let you get started more quickly and typically give you features "for free", but can be diffi...

7. Another Gaussian approximation

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 31 May 2026 16:15:49 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/31/another-gaussian-approximation/>

The function $(1 + \cos(x))/2$ gives a fair approximation to the Gaussian density $\exp(-x^2)$ You can make the approximation much better by raising it to a power. The function $((1 + \cos(x))/2)^4$ gives a good lower bound and $((1 + \cos(x))/2)^{3.5597}$ gives a good upper bound. More on that here. There are other ways of [?] The post Another Gaussian approximation first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Please don't mess with links:

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Sun, 31 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: https://maurycyz.com/misc/real_links/

A link is just a button that takes you somewhere when you click it right? style > span { text-decoration : underline ; color : #44EEEE ; } style > span onclick = "window.location='https://xkcd.com/'" >100% legit link span > span.link { text-decoration: underline; color: var(--link-color1); } 100% legit link Except that's a pale, shallow imitation of a link. A real link can be: Opened in a new tab. (ctrl) ... or a fresh window. (shift) ... or saved as a file (alt). Copied as a URL (right click) Used with the keyboard (tab + enter) Seen by tools like search engines and screen readers. Hovered over to see the URL. ... none of which work with a button. Another common offense is to use a real link, but hook the click event to open a popup. However, with a real link, I can: See the loading progress... ... or/and cancel it. ... see descriptive error pages and retry if needed. Open multiple at once. Read the original page while it loads. Use my browser's tabs or/and window manager to organize them. Bookmark the page. Copy the URL and send it to a friend. ... and above all, they are consistent: I've long lost count of how many times I've accidentally closed the whole site while trying to c...

9. Who are the actors in the UK's 2015 passport?

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 31 May 2026 11:34:08 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/who-are-the-actors-in-the-uks-2015-passport/>

I got nerdsniped by a bloody Reddit post! In 2015, the UK Government launched a new passport design. It immediately attracted negative press for its designers' "sexist" decision to feature more men than women. The government has been accused of sexism over the new UK passport design, which commemorates the achievements of two women but seven men. It's true that there are only two named women - ?

10. Be thou not pilld

Source: Westenberg. | Published: Sun, 31 May 2026 23:21:45 GMT

Link: <https://www.joanwestenberg.com/be-thou-not-pilled/>

A Scottish journalist named Charles Mackay published a book about the way crowds lose their minds. *Extraordinary Popular Delusions and the Madness of Crowds* (1841) catalogued tulip speculation, alchemy, the South Sea Bubble, witch hunts, and the slow-burn lunacy of people who grow so attached to an idea that they

11. Ahoy, DECmate II! the little PDP-8 that could

Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-05-30T19:19:49.552-07:00

Link: <https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/05/ahoy-decmate-ii-little-pdp-8-that-could.html>

In 1982, as we mentioned at length with our history of the DEC Professional, Digital Equipment Corporation attempted to keep their PDP-11 minicomputer market-relevant by turning the venerable architecture into a largely incompatible desktop microcomputer. But that wasn't the only PDP-series mini it happened to, and it wasn't even the first: the PDP-8 actually got the shrink-ray treatment several years before, and not content to merely make it into a smaller general purpose computer, DEC turned it into a word processor. Thus emerged the DECmates, descended from the 1977 DECstation VT78; arguably the zenith of the line was this one, the DECmate II, which rolled off the assembly line in 1982 simultaneously with the first DEC Professional models and the DEC Rainbow. Advertised aggressively to offices new to computers, take the two floppy disk drives built-in, add a printer, monitor and keyboard, and right away you had a simple office system for basic needs. With a Z80 or an 8086 processor card, you could turn it into an overgrown CP/M machine or a rather limited MS-DOS one. You could stick two more floppy drives in it. You could even add a hard disk or a graphics card, as long as you...

12. One &udm After Another

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-05-31T00:43:46Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17351430/google-ai-udm14-reflection>

Google made everyone mad again, so another wave of people just learned about &udm=14. Maybe we should all take the hint.

13. Micro Instrumentation and Telemetry Systems

Source: Abort Retry Fail | Published: Mon, 01 Jun 2026 01:28:37 GMT

Link: <https://www.abortretry.fail/p/micro-instrumentation-and-telemetry>

Rockets, calculators, and personal computers at MITS

14. A day in the threatened forests of the Central Highlands

Source: Dr Paris Buttfield-Addison | Published: Sun, 31 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://hey.paris/posts/threatened-forests/>

We spent today in some of the forests up in lutruwita/Tasmania's Central Highlands that are being logged, or are about to be. It was a Bob Brown Foundation Threatened Forest Open Day. It was sobering and a bit sad. Also fascinating, and the forest is beautiful. The marquee, set up in the forest. It rained pretty much all day. The marquee was up in the middle of the forest and we stood under it while a few people talked. They went through what's happening to these forests and what's scheduled to be cut. I got a lot out of it.

15. the totalisator

Source: computers are bad | Published: 31 May 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-05-31-totalisator.html>

It has been an unfortunate turn in the software industry, one of many as of late, that gambling is once again one of its primary engines. With the rise of almost nationwide online sports betting, not to mention prediction markets, making odds on real-world events and extracting the money of suckers is no longer limited to island nations. It is a great American pursuit, or at least, that's what modern television sports coverage leads you to believe. There has always been an uncomfortable relationship between software and the manipulation of marks. Techniques developed by casinos became a fundamental part of consumer software, while the software industry wholeheartedly embraced "gaming" as a market (the older meaning of the term here,

meaning gambling). We can readily point to a couple of reasons: first, gambling is profitable, and technology is first and foremost a means of accumulation. Second, gambling is mathematical, or at least arithmetical, in nature. Most forms of gambling involve some sort of complex calculation with real-world stakes. Gambling predates history, or it might be better to say that gambling has been around for as long as recorded history has been able to obser...

16. C++ iostreams: Unexpected but legal multithreaded behaviour

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 17 Mar 2019 17:46:37 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/iostreams-unexpected/>

In previous articles, I've waxed rhapsodic about how great C++ is. I also noted there however that every language, C++ included, has its dark sides. Some languages have an unavoidable pervasive dark side, like being slow or hard to multithread, for C++ that dark side is mostly its complexity. In this post I want to zoom in on a specific 'gotcha' that recently took me several hours to resolve. I wrote this piece so anyone running into the same issue might find out about it if they search the web.

17. What I Did in 2018

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 30 Dec 2018 14:26:04 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/what-i-did-in-2018/>

This is a more personal post than I usually write, and it was prompted by several people asking what I had been up to lately. It turns out that it is somewhat of a story. It is a long story too. Since the beginning of 2018 day to day management of PowerDNS is now truly in the hands of professionals. I'm very proud to report that PowerDNS has not only survived the transition to Open-Xchange but is actually thriving & has achieved sufficient revenues & talented staff that we've solved the famous open source 'what if Bert gets hit by a bus' problem.

18. Liveblog: a Mars landing watch party with school kids

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 27 Nov 2018 12:26:28 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/liveblog/>

Yesterday, NASA landed its InSight mission on Mars, and it all worked! The landing happened between 8 and 9PM local time, but I wanted to share the excitement with my kids' classmates from school (aged between around 9 and 10), so I needed something that worked remotely. NASA provided a wonderful webcast in English, and although many children here in The Netherlands can follow that, I expected the stream to need more narration for the kids to truly experience the excitement of landing on another planet.